



AFRICA CSID NEWSLETTER

Jan - March 2026 Edition

WELCOME TO OUR FIRST NEWSLETTER FOR 2026!

We are excited to share the latest updates from our programs and activities.

This edition highlights transformative initiatives, funding opportunities, and impactful community projects worldwide

"As we come to a close of the first quarter of the year, we reflect with pride on the collective achievements of our diverse and growing network—one that transcends national and local boundaries and amplifies the voices of the "hard to reach" and those at the forefront of community action.

By elevating local perspectives, we have contributed to significant governance shifts, ensuring that policies and solutions reflect the realities of those most affected. The impact of providing rapid support and guidance for locally led action is becoming increasingly evident.

The initiatives highlighted in this edition are already demonstrating tangible results, and with continuous support, their scalability and replication can drive lasting change.

Looking ahead, we remain committed to leveraging our strengths as an organization, resources, and partnerships to extend our reach, enhance visibility, and deepen our impact beyond 2026. However, we recognize that this mission cannot be achieved in isolation.

We call on like-minded organizations, donors, and philanthropists to join us in sustaining and scaling this vital work. We invite you to be inspired by the powerful stories emerging from our implementing countries and communities and to collaborate with us in driving just, inclusive, and community-led action."

Salome Owuonda
Executive Director, Africa CSID

IN THIS EDITION

▶ Executive Director's Message

Read about the initiatives and collaborations that were the highlights for our programme.

▶ Programme Highlights

Read about the initiatives and collaborations that were the highlights for our programme.

▶ Ongoing Projects Highlights

Read about the initiatives and collaborations that were the highlights for our programme.

▶ Events and Opportunities

See our past and upcoming events and opportunities

▶ Contacts

Read about the initiatives and collaborations that were the highlights for our programme.

BUILDING INCLUSIVE CLIMATE ACTION ACROSS KENYA

Climate change is no longer a distant threat—it's reshaping Kenya's daily reality. From prolonged droughts to flash floods, shifting rainfall to rising temperatures, communities are feeling the strain in their farms, water sources, health systems, and livelihoods. These challenges are most visible at the county level, where families and local institutions face climate shocks head-on.

But Kenya is also responding with innovation and resilience. To ensure that climate solutions reflect the voices of women, youth, and marginalized groups, the Government of Kenya developed the **National Gender and Climate Change Action Plan (NGCCAP)**. This groundbreaking framework places inclusion at the heart of climate policy, ensuring that strategies and investments meet the needs of diverse communities.

To bring NGCCAP to life, **Africa CSID** partnered with the **State Department for Gender and Affirmative Action**, the **State Department for Environment and Climate Change**, and the **Climate Change Directorate**, with support from the **Government of Canada's federal Department of Environment and Climate Change**, through the **NDC Partnership**.

Together, we rolled out regional dissemination and capacity-building workshops across Kenya's economic blocs. These sessions connected county leaders, civil society, and community representatives, equipping them with tools to embed gender-responsive approaches into climate governance.

The workshops were more than training—they were spaces of dialogue, solidarity, and vision. They strengthened local capacity, sparked collaboration, and reaffirmed Kenya's commitment to climate justice that is also gender justice.

Key Insights across the 5 Regions

Some of the key insights from the regions in general included:

- Community-led action was emphasized, with calls to leverage local leaders and address urban challenges such as waste management.
- Governance integration was highlighted, noting that gender mainstreaming must move beyond planning stages into full implementation.
- Persistent norms around land ownership and leadership remain barriers, though shifting dynamics show growing empowerment of women and girls.
- Capacity gaps in climate and gender knowledge, coupled with language barriers, limit community understanding.
- Finance and accountability challenges persist, with minimal allocations for participation and engagement.

NGCCAP DISSEMINATION IN COUNTIES

LREB: KISUMU



The Lake Region Economic Bloc (LREB) brought incredible energy to the NGCCAP dissemination workshops. From Kisumu's bustling lakeside communities to the fertile highlands of Nyamira and Vihiga, counties across the bloc showcased how local strengths can drive inclusive climate solutions.

Each department added a distinct voice to the conversation: agriculture teams celebrated the region's fertile soils and farming traditions, championing climate-smart practices that uplift women and youth farmers.

Environment and water officers underscored the need to safeguard Lake Victoria's ecosystems while keeping fisheries livelihoods resilient. Gender representatives emphasized the strength of community networks, ensuring women, youth, and marginalized groups remain central to climate planning. Livestock and disaster-risk teams stressed adaptive strategies to shield families from droughts and disease, with a focus on fair access to resources.

What stood out most was the spirit of collaboration. The LREB counties demonstrated that when the different departments; energy, agriculture, environment, gender, and resilience efforts converge, climate governance becomes more inclusive and transformative.

ADVANCING GENDER-RESPONSIVE CLIMATE ACTION

NORTH RIFT - ELDORET



The North Rift counties brought remarkable energy to the NGCCAP dissemination workshops. From Uasin Gishu's expansive farmlands to the lush highlands of Nandi and Elgeyo Marakwet, and the vibrant communities of Bungoma, the region showcased how local strengths can power inclusive climate solutions.

The workshop opened a space for dialogue and innovation, weaving together expertise from across departments and groups. North Rift counties demonstrated that when agriculture, environment, gender, and resilience efforts converge, climate governance becomes not only stronger—but more inclusive and transformative.

Each department added a distinct voice to the conversation: agriculture teams celebrated the region's role as Kenya's breadbasket, championing climate-smart practices that uplift women and youth farmers. Environment officers underscored the need to protect forests, rivers, and highland ecosystems that sustain communities.

Gender representatives emphasized the strength of grassroots networks, ensuring women, youth, and marginalized groups remain central to climate planning. Livestock and disaster-risk teams stressed adaptive strategies to shield families from droughts, pests, and disease, with a focus on fair access to resources.

PWANI - MOMBASA



The Pwani counties brought a distinctive coastal perspective to the NGCCAP dissemination workshops. From Mombasa's dynamic urban hub to the vibrant communities of Kilifi and Kwale, the region highlighted how coastal resilience and community strength can shape inclusive climate action.

The workshops were marked by lively exchanges and shared vision. They became spaces where diverse expertise met, showing that when departments work side by side, climate governance gains both depth and inclusivity.

Each sector contributed its own emphasis: agriculture teams drew attention to the region's blend of farming and fisheries, promoting practices that open opportunities for women and youth. Environmental officers focused on safeguarding fragile coastlines and marine ecosystems while sustaining ocean-based livelihoods.

Gender representatives underscored the importance of community solidarity, ensuring that women, youth, and marginalized groups remain central to planning. Livestock and disaster-risk teams highlighted adaptive measures to protect households from floods, droughts, and disease, with fairness in resource access at the core.

MOUNT KENYA AND ABERDARES: KIAMBU



The Mount Kenya and Aberdares region brought a powerful voice to the NGCCAP dissemination workshops.

From Kiambu's dynamic urban-rural mix to the fertile lands of Kirinyaga and Embu, and the resilient communities of Tharaka etc., the counties highlighted how their highland strengths can anchor inclusive climate action.

Each sector contributed its perspective: agriculture teams emphasized the region's role in sustaining Kenya's food systems, promoting climate-smart practices that open opportunities for women and youth. Environmental officers focused on protecting forests, rivers, and biodiversity hotspots that are vital to national water security.

Gender representatives underscored the importance of community solidarity, ensuring women, youth, and marginalized groups remain central to planning. Livestock and disaster-risk teams highlighted adaptive measures to safeguard households from droughts, floods, and disease, with fairness in resource access at the core.

SOUTH EASTERN: NAIROBI



The South Eastern counties brought a strong voice to the NGCCAP dissemination workshops. From Kitui's expansive drylands to Machakos' growing urban centers and Makueni's vibrant farming communities, the region highlighted how resilience and innovation can drive inclusive climate action.

Each sector contributed its perspective: agriculture teams emphasized the importance of climate-smart farming to sustain food security in semi-arid conditions, with women and youth at the forefront of adaptation.

Environment officers focused on protecting fragile ecosystems and promoting sustainable water use in drought-prone areas. Gender representatives underscored the strength of community networks, ensuring that women, youth, and marginalized groups remain central to planning and decision-making.

Livestock and disaster-risk teams highlighted adaptive strategies to safeguard households from recurring droughts and disease, with fairness in resource distribution as a guiding principle.



(a) Women, Faith and Climate Security Project

Since convening the Pre-UNEA 7 gathering in Nairobi last December, our Women, Faith and Climate Security project has continued to build strong connections with women leaders across Kenya. That landmark event brought together women in government alongside grassroots peacebuilders from Baringo, Homabay, and Migori—counties where climate change has intensified resource conflicts and heightened the need for inclusive, community-driven solutions.



In the months following, our team has been actively engaging with these leaders and their communities, ensuring that the voices of women remain central in shaping responses to climate-related challenges. From dialogues on sustainable resource management to strengthening local peace efforts, the project has become a platform where faith, resilience, and leadership intersect to drive meaningful change.

Looking ahead, preparations are in full swing for the county-level gatherings scheduled for the third quarter of this year. The Africa CSID team is planning to be physically present on the ground in Baringo, Homabay, and Migori, working hand-in-hand with local women leaders to deepen collaboration and amplify impact. These gatherings will not only consolidate the progress made since Nairobi but also provide space for communities to co-create strategies that address the realities of climate insecurity while fostering peace and stability.

Momentum is building, and the energy from December's convening continues to inspire. As plans heighten, we remain committed to ensuring that women's leadership is recognized as a cornerstone of climate security and peacebuilding in Kenya and beyond.



(b) Agroforestry for Climate Mitigation, Women's Livelihoods, and Community Resilience PROJECT

Africa CSID is in Tanzania once again, working alongside communities to embrace a new vision for sustainable land use—one that blends ecological restoration with social inclusion. The **Agroforestry for Climate Mitigation, Women's Livelihoods, and Community Resilience project** is at the heart of this transformation.



Led by **ESSA Technologies Ltd.** in partnership with Africa CSID, and supported by **Climate Action Africa** through **Alinea International**, the project responds to Tanzania's **National Agroforestry Strategy (2024–2031)**. Its vision is bold: scale up agroforestry adoption to cut emissions, strengthen carbon sequestration, and improve rural livelihoods.

Already, the project is reaching farmers in Morogoro Region through workshops where women make up the majority of trainees. Nationally, it aligns with Tanzania's ambition to grow agroforestry adoption from four million to fifteen million farmers by 2031.

Three Pillars Driving the Project:

- **Agroforestry Adoption & Mapping:** Rolling out tree-crop systems to curb deforestation from slash-and-burn farming and charcoal production.
- **Gender Mainstreaming & Women's Empowerment:** Putting women at the heart of land decisions and carbon markets, boosting their skills, assets, and leadership.
- **MRV (Measurement, Reporting, & Verification):** Building robust systems to track carbon emissions and removals, from farms to national levels.

This is climate action with a human face—where ecological sustainability meets social inclusion, and women stand at the forefront of transformation.

(c) Seeds of Change Project

Our Seeds for Change Project continues to blossom in Nyatike. Over the past months, the project has moved from setup to tangible results, and the energy on the ground is inspiring.

At the heart of this progress is the demonstration farm, which we envision to become a vibrant hub of learning and productivity. The Kawino Women Group is contiously engaged, managing the farm, Black Soldier Fly (BSF) farming, and poultry.

The BSF unit has become a star performer—the fly numbers have immensely grown and is now helping the group turn organic waste into fertilizer, boosting soil fertility, and showcasing how innovation can reduce costs while protecting the environment.

Though the poultry farm faced certain setbacks due to disease, the group is determined to bounce back with stronger measures, working with our expert to find local solutions for the diseases.

We are also proud to report a milestone, the selection of one of the group's youth member for an 8-week agroecology accelerator training program—proof of the importance of actively taking action and how much impact can be created from collaboration.

Despite the challenges faced such as poultry deaths due to diseases, structural destructions due to extreme weather, the community's resilience shines through, positioning the group as a model of how grassroots innovation can tackle food insecurity and climate vulnerability.



(d) ZANZADAPT Project

This quarter, the Zanzibar Women Leadership in Adaptation Project (ZanzAdapt) has continued to build momentum, marking two years of transformative work across Pemba and Unguja. What began in early 2025 with a baseline survey then capacity building and has now resulted in the formation of the Community Action Groups (CAGs).



The CAGs have become more than just platforms—they are spaces of dialogue, innovation, and collective action. Over the past months, they have amplified women's leadership stories, championed inclusive governance of natural resources, and fostered intergenerational approaches that bridge knowledge gaps. These efforts are not only strengthening women's agency but also ensuring that climate adaptation strategies reflect the realities of families, farmers, and fisherfolk across Zanzibar.



In this quarter, Africa CSID has worked alongside partners to deepen the reach of these groups, supporting advocacy campaigns, facilitating community dialogues, and promoting equitable access to land and resources. The outcomes are clear: women leaders are stepping forward with confidence, communities are organizing around shared priorities, and adaptation planning is becoming more inclusive and responsive.

(e) Nyatike Schools Evergreen Program (NYASEP)

In Nyatike Constituency, where communities face the harsh realities of drought, erratic rainfall, and degraded landscapes, a new chapter of hope is unfolding. The **Nyatike Schools Evergreen Program (NYASEP)** has been launched to transform schools into hubs of environmental stewardship, food security, and climate resilience.

The program began with a pilot phase across 10 schools, each establishing tree nurseries and kitchen gardens that will not only green their compounds but also nourish learners and surrounding communities.



Core activities include site preparation, seed sourcing, nursery establishment, and routine tree care, with learners from Grade 5 taking responsibility for nurturing at least one tree to maturity. Beyond trees, 4K Clubs are driving school kitchen gardens that support feeding programs, improve nutrition, and even generate income through surplus produce and seedlings.

The vision is clear: to move beyond tree planting into tree growing, embedding climate-smart agriculture and agroecology into everyday school life. By weaving environmental education into learning and community engagement, NYASEP is cultivating a generation of young stewards ready to restore Nyatike's landscapes and secure its future.



Dates	Event
May 2026	Last mile of the NGCCAP Dissemination Workshops : Nakuru and Isiolo. (Supported by GIZ)
8–18 June 2026	SB64 UN Climate Conference: Bonn
July 2026	Women, Faith and Climate Security community meetings (Baringo, Homabay & Migori
July 2026	Seeds of Change Symposium

Africa CSID is committed to amplifying locally-driven action in ways that embrace the voices of all community members, ensuring inclusivity and shared ownership in shaping resilient futures.

For more information about the organization, our agenda, and how to collaborate with us or if you have inspiration or tips, please contact us at info@afriacsid.org or visit our website www.afriacsid.org

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